

Table edge cases

GFM tables look simple but have several edge cases: ragged rows, alignment markers, escaped pipes, very wide and very narrow tables, and inline formatting in cells.

Minimal table

a	b
1	2

Wide table — 8 columns

col1	col2	col3	col4	col5	col6	col7	col8
a	b	c	d	e	f	g	h
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8

Should fit on a letter page in a sensible width or wrap gracefully.

Alignments

Left	Centre	Right
L1	C1	R1
L2 long content	C2	R2 short
short L3	C3 longer	12345

The first column should be left-aligned, the second centred, the third right-aligned.

Ragged rows

a	b	c
1		3
1	2	
	2	
1	2	3

The last row should drop the extra cell; the shorter rows should pad with empty cells.

Inline formatting in cells

Style	Example
bold	value
italic	<i>value</i>
code	va lue
link	click
mixed	<i>bold italic</i> code

Escaped pipes inside cells

a	b c	d
1	with pipe	3

The \ | should render as a literal pipe character, not a column separator.

Very long content in one cell

s h o r t	long
hi	This cell has a paragraph of content that may overflow the column width depending on how the renderer balances columns. It might wrap, it might shrink the other column, or it might overflow.
o k	Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit, sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna aliqua. Ut enim ad minim veniam, quis nostrud exercitation ullamco laboris nisi ut aliquip ex ea commodo consequat.

Table at the bottom of a page

This is filler to push the table down. Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit, sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna aliqua. Ut enim ad minim veniam, quis nostrud exercitation ullamco laboris nisi ut aliquip ex ea commodo

consequat. Duis aute irure dolor in reprehenderit in voluptate velit esse cillum dolore eu fugiat nulla pariatur. Excepteur sint occaecat cupidatat non proident, sunt in culpa qui officia deserunt mollit anim id est laborum.

only	one
row	here